

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY (INDIAN SCHOOL OF MINES),
DHANBAD

Mid-Semester Examination (Monsoon Semester) 2025-26

Class: B.Tech.
Duration: 1 Hour
Date: 19.09.2025

Course: NHSA101 Communication Skills
Max. Marks: 30
Time: 6pm—7pm

INSTRUCTION: All four parts of the question paper must be answered in one Answer Script. Answer the questions strictly in their respective parts.

Part I

1. Identify the errors in the following sentences and correct them. [Each question carries 1 mark] (8)

- Simpson, along with his friends, are planning to visit India to help the students write the CS exam but miss the flight.
- Neither Oggy's cooking experiments nor his cleaning skills makes the house look better, and the cockroaches was celebrating the mess.
- Hermit were chosen as a education partner during the CS class, and his slide of dancing crabs was enjoy by the whole class.
- Tom and Jerry was running across the library when the lecturer arrive and announce the exam results.
- ✓e. SpongeBob's essays, which is written on napkins, shows more creativity than Patrick's assignments does and receives high marks.
- f. The reason why Simpson missed the exam is because he don't studied last night and was sleeping in class.
- g. Oggy borrowed books from the library, it was very helpful for his project on a communication skill and contain useful diagrams.
- h. Hermit the crab have gave an excellent presentation on a importance of teamwork for underwater communities and explain it clearly.

Part II

2. Do as directed: [Each question carries 1 mark] (8)

- Prof. Leighton **steers clear of** playing with words. [Write a one-word meaning of the highlighted expression in the given context]
- The student is moderately taken to task for being **VOCAL** while answering the question in the class. [Add suitable prefix for the word written in upper case and rewrite the sentence]
- Bernard's hairs turn **RED** brown. [Add suitable suffix for the word written in the upper case and rewrite the sentence]
- The **BASHFULNESS** of Stephen is ridiculed in the board meeting. [Write a one-word **synonym** of the word written in the upper case]
- Janjira Fort looks quite **INVINCIBLE**. [Write a one-word **antonym** of the word written in the upper case]

- f. Mary is blessed with the **verbal eloquence**. [Replace the emboldened words with a suitable idiom]
- g. The workers _____ a financial crisis and ask for monetary aids. [Choose a suitable phrasal verb from the list below and rewrite the sentence]
[run over, run about, run into, run after]
- h. Thomas _____ his lecture with a positive note. [Choose a suitable phrasal verb from the list below and rewrite the sentence]
[rounded up, rounded off, rounded in, rounded on]

Part III

3. Read the passage carefully and answer the following questions below:

7

Revenge is a kind of wild justice; the more man's nature runs to it, the more the law ought to weed it out. The first wrong only offends against the law, but the revenge for that wrong takes over from the law. In taking revenge, a man is merely even with his enemy, but in passing it over he is his superior; for it is a prince's part to pardon; and I am sure that Solomon says, 'It is the glory of a man to pass by an offence'. That which is past is gone and irrevocable, and wise men have enough to do with things present and to come; so that those who labour over past matters merely trifle with themselves. When a man does a wrong, it is not for the wrong's sake but as a means to purchase for himself profit, or pleasure, or honour, or the like; so why should I be angry with a man for loving himself better than me? And if any man should do wrong merely out of ill-nature, that is like the thorn or briar, which pricks and scratches because that is all they can do. The least bad sort of revenge is for wrongs which there is no law to remedy; but when a man seeks revenge, let him take care that his revenge is not one that there is no law to punish; otherwise, his enemy is still beforehand, and it is two for one. Some, when they take revenge, want the offender to know where the revenge comes from. (The passage has been taken from Francis Bacon's "Of Revenge")

- A. (i) Why does the author consider revenge as a kind of wild justice? 2
(ii) Solomon says, "It is the glory of a man to pass by an offence."—Explicate the remark. 2
(iii) Why does a man commit wrong? 1

B. Write the meaning of the following words in the context of the given passage: 2
a. weed out b. trifle with

Part IV

4. Read the following passage and answer the questions: (Each question carries 1 mark)

7

Homing pigeons are placed in a training program from about the time they are twenty-eight days of age. They are taught to enter the loft through a trap and to exercise above and around the loft, and gradually they are taken away for short distances in wicker baskets and released. They are then expected to find their way home in the shortest possible time. In their training flights or in actual races, the birds are taken to prearranged distant points and released to find their way back to their own lofts. Once the birds are liberated, their owners, who are standing by at the home lofts, anxiously watch the sky for the return of their entries. Since time is of the essence, the speed with which the birds can be induced to enter the loft trap may make the difference between gaining a win or a second place. The head of a homing pigeon is comparatively small, but its brain is one quarter larger than that of the ordinary pigeon. The homing pigeon is very intelligent and will persevere to the point of stubbornness some have been known to fly a hundred miles off course to avoid a storm. Some homing pigeon experts claim that this bird is gifted with a form of built-in radar that helps it find its own loft after

hours of flight, for hidden under the head feathers are two very sensitive ears, while the sharp, prominent eyes can see great distances in daytime. Why do homing pigeons fly home? They are not unique in this inherent skill: it is found in most migratory birds, in bees, ants, toads, and even turtles, which have been known to travel hundreds of miles to return to their homes. But in the animal world the homing pigeon alone can be trusted with its freedom and trained to carry out the missions that people demand.

Questions

- What would be the possible title of the passage?
- What is the purpose of the passage?
- According to the passage, what happens to homing pigeons when they are about a month old?
- In the passage, when the author states that the owners "anxiously watch the sky"; what is the implication(s)?
- According to the passage, what is the difference between a homing pigeon and an ordinary one?
- Why does the author mention bees, ants, toads, and turtles in the last paragraph?
- Why does the author ask the question 'Why do homing pigeons fly home?' in the last paragraph?

(Homing Pigeon) - Trusted Mission
Completer